

stretches your financial limits is a socially accepted practice that has gone unchallenged for far too long, but that's starting to change.

It's time for a new kind of homeownership, one that does a lot more than just put a roof over your head. A smart home-buying decision will not only give you a place to live but also offer flexibility, financial stability, and the chance to recognize an increase in that home's value over time. By following all the steps outlined in this book, you will set yourself up for a smart home purchase at a great price, with as few snags as possible in the process.

STRANGER DANGER

Since you're about to make a whopper of a financial choice and you're going to follow our advice while doing it, allow us to introduce ourselves (and toot our own horns).

We're both experts on finance, home buying, and real estate investing, and we have more than thirty years of experience between us. We're cohosts of *The BiggerPockets Money Podcast*, which has been around since 2018 and (as of now) has more than 10 million downloads, 1,500 five-star reviews, and countless corny dad jokes. The show covers everything you can and should do to get your finances in order so you can save, invest, and ultimately win at life. After hundreds of interviews with brilliant financial experts, we have absorbed quite a bit of knowledge.

On the home-buying side, Mindy knows best. She's been buying and selling homes as an investor for more than twenty years, and she's been a licensed real estate agent for more than six. Mindy is currently occupying her eleventh live-in flip—which means she buys wonderfully hideous houses, moves in, makes them beautiful while living there, and sells them for a killer profit.

On the finance side, Scott knows his stuff—he's the CEO of [BiggerPockets.com](https://www.biggerpockets.com) and author of the best-selling finance book *Set for Life*. Not to mention that he achieved financial freedom and built a successful real estate business just three years after graduating college. (Yes, seriously.)

All horn tooting aside, we're here to help you make the best decision possible when it comes to buying your first home. We've seen both ends of the spectrum—the crash-and-burns and the wild success stories—and are